

Daily Bible Note

Date: September 10, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Psalm 119:137-152

137 Righteous are You, O LORD, And upright are Your judgments.

138 Your testimonies, which You have commanded, Are righteous and very faithful.

139 My zeal has consumed me, Because my enemies have forgotten Your words.

140 Your word is very pure; Therefore Your servant loves it.

141 I am small and despised, Yet I do not forget Your precepts.

142 Your righteousness is an everlasting righteousness, And Your law is truth.

143 Trouble and anguish have overtaken me, Yet Your commandments are my delights.

144 The righteousness of Your testimonies is everlasting; Give me understanding, and I shall live.

145 I cry out with my whole heart; Hear me, O LORD! I will keep Your statutes.

146 I cry out to You; Save me, and I will keep Your testimonies.

147 I rise before the dawning of the morning, And cry for help; I hope in Your word.

148 My eyes are awake through the night watches, That I may meditate on Your word.

149 Hear my voice according to Your lovingkindness; O LORD, revive me according to Your justice.

150 They draw near who follow after wickedness; They are far from Your law.

151 You are near, O LORD, And all Your commandments are truth.

152 Concerning Your testimonies, I have known of old that You have founded them forever.

II. Key Summary

- The psalmist declares that the LORD is righteous, His judgments upright, and His testimonies righteous and very faithful; His word is very pure, His law is truth, and His righteousness is everlasting (vv. 137-142, 144).
 - The psalmist says he is small and despised and that trouble and anguish have overtaken him, yet he does not forget God's precepts and calls God's commandments his delights; he is also consumed with zeal because his enemies have forgotten God's words (vv. 139, 141, 143).
 - The psalmist cries out for salvation with his whole heart, rising before dawn and staying awake through the night watches to meditate on God's word; he notes that those who follow wickedness draw near, while the LORD is near and His testimonies are founded forever (vv. 145-152).
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III. Passage Analysis

When you are looked down on, you need God's words even more

When we are small and despised we have the more need to remember God's precepts, that we may have them to support us under the pressures of a low condition. [1]

The psalmist does not say, "I'm impressive, so I can handle this." He says, "I am small and despised, yet I do not forget Your precepts." What holds him up is not how people rate him, but the fact that what God said has not changed.

They draw near, but You are near

Note the realism of the double statement, They draw near...but thou art near. The threat is not glossed over; it is put in perspective by a bigger fact. [2]

The psalmist does not pretend the pressure isn't real. He holds two things together: the trouble really is closing in, and God is closer still. Faith isn't shrinking the problem; it's knowing Someone is nearer than it is.

IV. Reflection Question

What is closing in on you lately that makes you feel like you can't hold on much longer?

The psalmist didn't pretend it wasn't there — he just kept saying one other thing at the same time: "You are near, O LORD."

References

[1] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry's Commentary (Psalm 119:141),

https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/Psa/Psa_119.cfm

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik's Commentary (Psalm 119:150-151, citing Derek Kidner),

<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/psalm-119/>